

Mandarin-collar fitted blouse

EU38 sewing guide . 8 pieces . 2.3 m fabric at 140 cm

text-first guide, no illustrations in this edition. Every step is the engine's own instruction.

Cut list

Top Center Front - cut 1 on fold

Top Side Front - cut 2

Top Center Back - cut 2

Top Side Back - cut 2

Front Neck Facing - cut 1 on fold, interface

Back Neck Facing - cut 2, interface

Sleeve - cut 2

Stand Collar (dik yaka) - cut 2 on fold at centre back (1 self + 1 interfacing), band stands at the neckline; ease none the bottom

Steps

1. Print and check the 3 cm calibration square before cutting.
2. This block uses standard assumptions for shoulder slope and underbust sew a quick muslin first and adjust before cutting your real fabric.
3. Cut every piece as labelled ('on fold' on the fabric fold, 'cut 2' twice), sleeves twice. Check the neck opening against your head circumference a top has no zipper, it must slip over your head.
4. Fuse interfacing to the neck facings.
5. Staystitch the neckline just inside the seam line so it doesn't stretch while you work.
6. Sew each princess seam: pin center panel to side panel matching the bust notch, sew from armhole to hem in one pass, clip the curve over the bust inside the seam allowance, press toward the center.
7. Sew the shoulder seams and press them open.
8. Sew the front and back neck facings together at the shoulders; finish the facing's outer edge (zigzag, overlock or turn 5 mm and stitch).
9. Attach the facing to the neckline right sides together, sewing exactly on the seam line. Trim to 6 mm, clip into the curve every 2 cm.
10. Understitch: press the seam allowance toward the facing and stitch it to the facing 2 mm from the seam this is what keeps the facing rolled inside. Turn, press, and tack the facing down at the shoulder seams.
11. Sew the side seams.
12. Sew each sleeve seam, ease the cap between the notches and set the sleeves in.
13. Hem with a 2 cm double fold.

14. Front placket: this front carries an 18 mm grown-on button stand past the center front (marked fold line at CF, fold-back facing line inside). Interface the stand. Mark the buttonholes on THIS (right) front – one is placed at the bust level to stop gaping – and the buttons on the LEFT front on the center-front line (women's fronts lap right over left). Cut horizontal buttonholes starting 3 mm past the center front toward the edge, 21 mm long. Change the button size to suit and re-space if needed.
15. Collar (Stand Collar (dik yaka)): the band's bottom edge is drafted to the exact neckline length and curved up at centre front so it hugs the neck. Interface one layer, fold right sides together along the top edge, stitch the ends, turn, then sew the bottom edge to the neckline matching the centre-back fold and shoulder notches. No ease – the seam lines are equal length.